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Page 1 — Cover

Japan Cherry Blossom (Sakura) Trip Planner

Plan your hanami trip — bloom timing, best regions, itinerary & checklists.

A planning tool, not a guarantee. Sakura timing changes every year — always check current-year updates.

Page 2 — How Sakura Season Works (Read First)

Cherry blossom season is not a single fixed week. It moves across the country and shifts from year to year with the weather, so flexibility is your best tool.

- It moves south to north. Blossoms generally open earlier in warmer southern areas and progressively later as you go north and into higher elevations.
- The peak window is short. From first opening to full bloom is usually only a handful of days, and full bloom often lasts roughly a week before petals fall — weather (rain, wind, warmth) can shorten it.
- Timing shifts yearly. A warm or cold spell can move the peak earlier or later than a typical year. Treat any "usual" window as a rough guide only.
- Different varieties bloom at different times. Some trees open earlier and some later, which can stretch the overall viewing period in a given area.

Strategy: Pick a general window, build a flexible route, and have a backup region slightly earlier or later in the season so you can adjust toward wherever is closest to peak.

> ☒☒ Always confirm the current year's bloom updates from official local sources before locking in dates. Do not book non-refundable plans assuming a specific peak date.

Page 3 — How to Read Bloom Timing

Common terms you'll see in updates:

Term	What it usually means
First bloom / opening	The first few blossoms have opened on a benchmark tree in that area
Full bloom	The large majority of blossoms are open — the prime viewing window
Petal fall / late bloom	Petals are dropping; still scenic, with "blossom snow"

Tips for using updates:

- ☒ Check official local tourism or city sources for your target areas
- ☒ Look for *both* first-bloom and full-bloom estimates
- ☒ Re-check a week or two before you travel — estimates get refined as the date nears
- ☒ Build buffer days so you can shift toward an area near peak

☒ Remember higher-elevation and northern spots peak later — a useful "plan B"

All timing is an estimate. Weather can change everything. Confirm the latest before relying on any date.

Page 4 — Region Bloom Timing Overview

General, typical-year ordering only — not a forecast. Use it to sequence a route, then confirm current-year updates for each area.

Region type	Typical relative timing	Notes
Warm southern areas	Earliest in the season	Good if you're traveling early
Major central cities & lowlands	Mid-season	Most popular, busiest
Northern regions	Later in the season	Good "plan B" if central peak is missed
Mountain & high-elevation spots	Latest	Can extend your viewing window

My target regions (in season order):

1. _____ — confirm current-year timing: ☒
2. _____ — confirm current-year timing: ☒
3. _____ — confirm current-year timing: ☒

> ☒☒ Relative ordering is general guidance. Always verify each area's current-year estimate from official sources.

Page 5 — Trip Overview Worksheet

Field	Your plan
Travel dates	
Number of days	
Primary region(s)	
Backup region (earlier/later)	
Home base city/cities	
Travel pass / tickets to confirm	
Accommodation booked?	☒ Yes ☒ Pending
Refundable bookings?	☒ Yes ☒ No

Flexibility check:

- ☒ At least 1-2 buffer days built in
- ☒ Backup region identified (slightly earlier or later peak)
- ☒ Bookings refundable where possible
- ☒ Plan to re-check bloom updates ~2 weeks out

Page 6 — Hanami (Blossom Viewing Picnic) Planner

Hanami is the tradition of relaxing under the blossoms. A little planning makes it smooth.

Pick your spot:

- ☒ Confirm whether the park/area allows picnics and any rules
- ☒ Check opening hours (some spots have evening illumination — confirm dates)
- ☒ Have a backup nearby in case it's crowded
- ☒ Note nearest station/transport and restrooms

Picnic kit checklist:

- ☒ Ground sheet / mat
- ☒ Snacks & drinks (buy locally for convenience)
- ☒ Wet wipes & hand sanitizer
- ☒ Trash bag (bins are scarce — carry your trash out)
- ☒ Layers / blanket (spring evenings get cool)
- ☒ Reusable bag, small cushion
- ☒ Camera / phone + charged battery

Etiquette:

- Don't shake, pull, or climb trees, or pick blossoms.
- Keep noise reasonable and clean up completely.
- Don't block paths; leave space for others.
- Follow any posted rules for the specific park.

Page 7 — Daily Itinerary Page (print one per day)

Day ____ / Date _____ / Base: _____

Time	Plan / Spot	Transport	Notes
Morning			
Midday			
Afternoon			
Evening			

- Blossom spots today: _____
- Bloom status checked? ☒ Backup if not peak: _____
- Meals: _____
- Budget note: _____

Page 8 — Spring Packing Checklist

Spring weather swings between mild and chilly, with rain possible.

Clothing:

- ☒ Light layers (mornings/evenings are cool)
- ☒ A warm layer or light jacket
- ☒ Comfortable walking shoes
- ☒ Compact umbrella / rain layer
- ☒ Hat & sunglasses for sunny days

Daily carry:

- ☒ Picnic mat (if doing hanami)
- ☒ Trash bag, wet wipes
- ☒ Reusable water bottle
- ☒ Phone, charger, battery pack
- ☒ IC transit card / tickets
- ☒ Some cash + a card
- ☒ Allergy meds / tissues (spring pollen)

Photo gear (optional):

- ☒ Phone/camera, extra battery
- ☒ Lens cloth
- ☒ Lightweight tripod (check if allowed at your spots)

Page 9 — Crowd & Comfort Tips

- Go early or late. Popular spots fill up midday; early mornings and weekday visits are calmer.
- Weekdays beat weekends for crowds where your schedule allows.
- Evening illuminations can be magical but busy — confirm whether and when they run.
- Have a plan B spot nearby for every main spot.
- Pace yourself. Don't pack too many spots into one day; blossoms reward slow strolls.
- Weather matters. A rainy or windy day can speed petal fall — be ready to flex.

Page 10 — Final Checklist & Notes

Before you go:

- ☒ Current-year bloom updates checked for each target area
- ☒ Route sequenced south→north (or by elevation) with a backup
- ☒ Buffer days in place
- ☒ Refundable bookings where possible
- ☒ Spring layers + rain gear packed
- ☒ Transport passes/tickets confirmed

Notes:

> Sakura timing can never be guaranteed. Stay flexible, confirm the latest official updates, and enjoy whatever stage of bloom you find — even early buds and falling petals are part of the experience.